



consistent and high-quality customer experience, we needed seamless automation but at a low cost. An accelerated rollout and rapid scalability of our services was critical for early success. Thus, we chose Red Hat Enterprise Linux Advanced Platform,” says Mohit Agarwal, chief information officer, Carnation Auto.

Open source gear

Implementing open source technology was not easy. The intensive lifecycle management that Carnation wished to provide to its customers demanded a centralised IT system that would be a single window to address the various needs of multiple stakeholders (customers, business partners and employees). For this, the company chose the SAP business suite.

The simplicity in managing the infrastructure, scalability and performance compatibility of the SAP business suite and HP ProLiant servers, coupled with low cost solutions, led to the decision to go for open source technology.

“We considered a number of operating systems as the platform for our business-critical SAP applications, and selected Red Hat Enterprise Linux Advanced Platform because it provided the best overall value, stability and performance,” says Agarwal.

On the fast track

There has been no looking back since then. Open source technology helped Carnation reduce costs, improve the performance of the IT infrastructure and achieve scalability, thereby propelling the firm onto the fast track.

Carnation Auto went live with SAP about four months back and has achieved a good performance from SAP’s business suite atop Linux. Today, the firm has 15 live sites,

with 400 users. So far, it has used only 10 per cent of its server capacity.

“We are a distributed business. The final performance of SAP depends on multiple factors, of which one is the platform. With open source, we haven’t had any performance issues despite the number of users increasing to 400 today. Not an hour of user productivity in terms of system downtime has been lost ever since we implemented the solution,” testifies Agarwal.

Response time is also critical to a system that is partly exposed to customers, as any performance delay would adversely affect the customers’ confidence in the solution.

“For our customers, the Carnation experience should never be dented. Linux allows the SAP business suite to aggregate information across domains, and it enables a customer-facing front-end that performs like a retail operation,” adds Agarwal.

SAP’s commitment to Linux as a long-term strategic and supported platform for customers worldwide also assured Carnation a solution with end-to-end support—from the hardware to the OS, and through to the business applications.

Further, Linux is highly scalable, which complements Carnation’s growth plans. “We wish to open 100 hubs in the next three years and increase our user base on SAP to over 3,000 users. We are confident of Linux having the ability to help us achieve such scalability. Today, we can see ourselves grow ten times on the same platform without any issues, with

“We are looking at over 30 per cent cost savings from IT investments in Red Hat solutions over the next five years.”

—Mohit Agarwal, chief information officer, Carnation Auto

